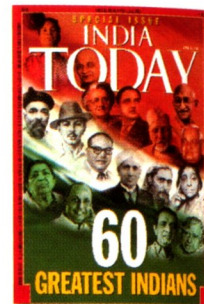


SIPRA DAS



"60 Greatest Indians",
April 21, 2008

"The issue will play an important role in propagating the legacies of these great Indians and instilling nationalism in young Indians."

VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

Great Endeavour

The special issue made for an interesting reading and the true-life stories shall inspire many potential leaders to crystallise their energies into achieving greatness ("60 Greatest Indians", April 27).

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

A man who should not have been left out in an issue such as this was Dr C. Rajagopalachari, the first Indian governor general and the greatest statesman ever.

BHARAT R. SANT, *Hyderabad*

While going through the issue, one felt sad to think that the glorious era of ideals and arts is coming to an end and the remaining torchbearers of that period too will disappear from the scene soon. Their place will be usurped by classes bereft of values, an example of which is

the IPL, which resembles slave trade.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

The issue came as a disappointment for many Keralites as it did not include Sree Narayan Guru, a father figure in the state's renaissance movement. The Keralite included—E.M.S. Namboodiripad—had done more harm to the state than good.

K.P. JOSEPH, *Kochi*

Rating great Indians on the basis of mere 18,928 votes is ridiculous. It resembles the polls for shows like *Indian Idol*, where people do not vote on the basis of the contestants' merits. It is unfair to rate these men on the basis of such an insignificant number of votes.

RAHUL KUMAR, *on e-mail*

Lest one forget them in the daily grind of life in a fast growing nation, your special issue is inarguably a

monumental endeavour. It re-emphasises the importance of the contributions of 60 luminaries of 20th century India, who, through their grit and determination, enriched and moulded the fine contours of modern India.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

It was astonishing to find that no name from the spiritual world has been included in the list. You should have at least included Sri Sri Ravi Shankar, who is known all over for the world for his crusade for love, peace and compassion.

LAKHI ROCHWANI, *Mumbai*

Do tell us what A.B. Vajpayee, whom you put on the cover, has done that he will be remembered by the nation. Nehru has given more enduring gifts to the nation and he still could not find a place on the cover.

K. KITCHLU, *Mysore*

The list has enough colour and glitter, but anyone with a sense of objectivity would label it incomplete. It didn't have M.G. Ramachandran, one of the most popular actor-politicians of all times; Osho, a spiritual genius; or even Sri Aurobindo, who was easily the most multi-dimensional Indian ever born.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN, *on e-mail*

It was surprising to note that Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa, considered the Father of the Indian Army, was not featured among the 60 Greatest Indians.

K.M. MACHIAH, *Bangalore*

The result of the poll reaffirmed our ideals. To see that the supreme sacrifices by Bhagat Singh and Subhas Chandra Bose are remembered by not only the old, but the new generation as well was heartening. However, it was sad to see former prime minister Lal